

P?S/8 System Programs Directory Internal Structures

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Unlike most operating systems, P?S/8 maintains a separate directory for core-image system programs. This allows highly specialized entries tailored to the individual requirements of each program including certain command-line parsing variations as needed, and the ability to maintain internal overlays. The P?S/8 command-line mechanism supports many features that are akin to Concise Command Language [CCL] as implemented in other systems with system-specific variations. Certain aspects of the commands are managed by control bits in the entries for each system program; this is especially vital for programs that are implemented as overlays to the keyboard monitor.

Figure 1 shows the entire systems program directory particular to the TC01/TC08 configuration including all specific program details. [Note: This listing can be obtained using P?S/8 DIRECT with the /S switch (and possibly additional options) set; for more information, consult separate documentation of P?S/8 DIRECT.]

P?S/8 System Directory DIRECT V10b Thursday 02-Jul-15 Page 1										
System: TC08:0										
Image Information:										
Name	Block	Size	Load	Length	Out	In	R	S	O	Start
ODT	0163	016	0000	16	GENO	GENI	0	0	0	03000
BATCH	0201	002	7400	01		BAT	0	0	0	07400
BIN	0203	027	0000	13	BIN	BIN	0	0	0	00200
GET	0203	027	0000	13	BIN	BIN	0	0	0	00600
START	0203	027	0000	13	GENO	GENI	0	0	0	00400
DUMP	0232	007	0000	07		DUMP	0	0	0	01400
CHANGE	0241	003	1200	03			1	1	0	01600
FIND	0241	003	1200	03			1	1	0	01200
BSAVE	0244	006	3000	06	BIN		0	0	1	03000
PAL	0252	102	0000	37	BIN	PAL	0	0	0	00200
MAP	0354	012	0000	12		BIN	0	0	0	01200
BLKODT	0366	011	0000	11			0	0	0	02000
SET	0377	013	3000	13			1	1	0	03000
CORE	0412	002	3000	02			0	1	0	03000
DATE	0414	012	3000	12			0	1	0	03000
PRINT	0426	014	0000	14		PAL	1	0	0	00200
FILMAN	0442	024	2600	24			0	1	0	07000
ALLCAT	0466	003	3000	03			0	1	0	03000
CONSOL	0471	040	3000	20		BIN	0	0	0	03000
FOCAL	0531	041	0000	37		FOC	0	0	0	03400
OS8CON	0572	012	0000	12	ASC	ASC	0	0	0	00200
SYSTAT	0604	014	0000	14			0	0	0	00200
DIRECT	0620	023	2600	23			1	1	0	07200
BLKCPY	0643	026	0000	26			0	0	0	00200
RK4MAT	0671	021	0000	21			0	0	0	02200
DT4MAT	0712	014	0000	14			0	0	0	02600
DTCOPY	0726	007	0000	07			0	0	0	00000
<free>	0735	043								
Free Slots:		072								

Figure 1: System Directory Printout of P?S/8 Version 8Z for TC08.

Figure 2 shows the contents of the first block of the system programs directory. Each program entry occupies six words:

Word 1-3: The program name in six-bit [text] format. All trailing characters of names shorter than six characters are 00. Any character that is valid for a Tiny File System [TFS] file name is valid for a system program name. This includes characters such as \, ^, [and].

Word 4: The starting block number for the program. The contents of this block [and any relevant adjacent blocks] will be loaded into memory when an execution-class keyboard monitor command initiates the program.

Word 5: This word contains several sets of loading and parsing information:

Bits[0-4] contain the loading address of the system program [which must conform to full page boundaries].

Bits[7-11] contain the length [in 128-word blocks] of the initial loading segment of the program. [Note: All programs without overlay structures do not have secondary segments. Programs that include overlays define their own internal structures as required. For example, P?S/8 FOCAL includes several secondary segments that are loaded into memory by FOCAL in specific circumstances; P?S/8 PAL has a similar set of secondary segments of program code and a data segment that consists of the internal symbol table that is loaded into memory as determined by dynamic memory allocation considerations.]

If Bit[5] is set, the command processor will not scan for [input or output] filenames. Certain programs are designed to process the rest of the command line directly. For example, the P?S/8 CORE program sets this bit to allow processing of various in-line arguments that must not be confused with filenames.

If Bit[6] is set, processing of an =xxxx expression will occur in the current radix setting within the keyboard monitor. Otherwise, the expression is always processed as octal notation. For example, the P?S/8 FIND program locates strings within file lines [within the edit buffer of the keyboard monitor] matching a specified string. The search can be limited to a starting line number expressed as =xxxx in the current radix setting within the keyboard monitor.

Word 6: This word contains several sets of startup and parsing information:

Bits[0-4] contains the startup address for the program. [Note: As of P?S/8 Version 8Z, all system programs must start on full page boundaries. Future releases may change this.]

If Bit[5] is set the parsing of input files is inhibited. For example, the P?S/8 BSAVE program must be passed output files without input files. After the input/output separator character ["<" or ">" according to the user's preference] has been processed, the list of output files is always processed first. All command-line input beyond the separator character must be available to BSAVE for direct processing. This section of the command consists of individual memory locations or groups of contiguous locations to be saved in the binary output files; however, if input file processing were not inhibited, certain memory location specifications could be mistaken for input files.

Bits[6-11] are used for passive cosmetic purposes only. Various combinations of potential input and output file types have been defined. The P?S/8 DIRECT program output as shown in Figure 1 includes the designated values for all programs that are ordinarily used with input files or output files [or both].

Note: Future releases of P?S/8 will likely drop support of the present usage of Bits[5-11] in word 6. The bits will be repurposed to allow program starting addresses to be extended into the range of 000-077 past the start of a page boundary.

```

BLOCK: 0:0063
0000 1704 2400 0000 0163 0016 3001 0201 2403 *ODT@@@A3@NXABATC*
0010 1000 0201 7401 7411 0211 1600 0000 0203 *H@BA<A<IBIN@@@BC*
0020 0013 0203 0705 2400 0000 0203 0013 0603 *@KBCGET@@@BC@KFC*
0030 2324 0122 2400 0203 0013 0401 0425 1520 *START@BC@KDADUMP*
0040 0000 0232 0007 1412 0310 0116 0705 0241 *@@BZ@GLJCHANGE8!*
0050 1343 1600 0611 1604 0000 0241 1343 1200 *K#N@FIND@B!K#J@*
0060 0223 0126 0500 0244 3006 3104 2001 1400 *BSAVE@BSXFYDPAL@*
0070 0000 0252 0037 0207 1501 2000 0000 0354 *@@B*_@_BGMAP@@@C,*
0100 0012 1202 0214 1317 0424 0366 0011 2000 *@JJB8LKODTC6@IP@*
0110 2305 2400 0000 0377 3153 3000 0317 2205 *SET@@@C?Y+X@CORE*
0120 0000 0412 3102 3000 0401 2405 0000 0414 *@@DJYBX@DATE@DL*
0130 3112 3000 2022 1116 2400 0426 0054 0215 *YJX@PRINT@DV@,BM*
0140 0611 1415 0116 0442 2724 7000 0114 1403 *FILMAND"WT8@ALLC*
0150 0124 0466 3103 3000 0317 1623 1714 0471 *ATD6YCX@CONSOLD9*
0160 3020 3002 0617 0301 1400 0531 0037 3413 *XPBFOCAL@EY@_K*
0170 1723 7003 1716 0572 0012 0205 2331 2324 *OS8CONE:@JBESYST*

```

Figure 2: Dump of Block 0063 of P?S/8 Version 8Z for TC08.

Figure 3 shows the contents of the second block of the system programs directory. Several empty entries exist in this block indicating there is ample room for additional system programs. [Note: To add a significant amount of system programs, the system device must be much larger than a DECTape or other small storage medium. Larger devices can address up to block 7777 which would allow such additional image program support.]

P?S/8 execution is initiated by one of two methods: concise command execution [starting the command with the program name], or by use of the R [or RU(n) command specifying the desired program by name. [Note: In the current release, the RU(n) command is an alias for the R command; either can be used interchangeably.]

When the R command method is used, the entire directory is available for system programs; in this mode of usage, a total of 125 octal [85 decimal] system programs can be accommodated. Figure 1 indicates 072 octal [58 decimal] slots are available as the system directory currently contains 33 octal [27 decimal] programs.

When concise command execution is used, a restriction is made to only access entries wholly contained in the first two blocks. [Note: Any entry past relative word[173] of the second system directory block is destroyed in memory by the command processor.] As such, when concise command execution is used, the maximum number of accessible slots is reduced to 52 octal [42 decimal]. For the system directory used in the example, 17 octal [15 decimal] programs can still be added while also totally avoiding the possibility of not being available for the concise execution method.

Note: The two methods of initiating program execution have several tradeoffs:

- 1) Certain programs are implemented as overlays to the keyboard monitor such as the FIND program used to locate string matches within the tentative file buffer of the keyboard monitor. Only the concise execution form preserves the contents of the editing buffer; attempting to use FIND via the method of R FIND would be moot as the edit buffer contents are destroyed.
- 2) Certain programs such as P?S?8 OS8CON can be executed to make use of the extended user directory for the purpose of creating variable-length files. The concise execution form cannot access the extended-length file directory.

The general recommendation is to place programs with little interaction with P?S/8 resources in higher blocks to ensure programs implemented as overlays to always be executable by the concise method. These generally include device formatting or diagnostic programs designed for standalone usage [with the paper-tape loading programs RIM or BIN.]

Note: The data structure of the extended-length file directory is undergoing major redesign. As originally intended, it was foreseen that P?S/8 might attempt to include certain aspects of variable-length files in a more general-purpose way than merely one extended-length file per system device logical unit; however, no version of P?S/8 ever supported more than read access to the first file and the file name had to be manually entered into the first entry in the extended-length files directory.

with the implementation of the P?S/8 SHELL [currently under development] this entire facility is being eliminated in favor of a single entry placed at the end of the system programs directory. As such, the maximum number of system programs available to the R command will be reduced from 125 octal [85 decimal] to 124 octal [84 decimal]. Since the entry for the single extended-length file will be loaded into memory along with the rest of the system programs directory, overall command efficiency will be notably improved.

Appropriate modifications will be made to the P?S/8 SET command to accommodate the single extended-length file in a meaningful way; it will no longer be necessary to enter the file name manually.

Due to this design change, the R form of execution cannot access the extended-length directory presently. A work-around is available as follows:

The Tiny File System [TFS] directory manages all blocks up the block just before the extended-length file directory area. As such, a TFS file entry can be placed at the last allowed file slot. This file entry will start exactly 20 octal [16 decimal] blocks before the [first] extended-length file. As such, an extended-length file can be created and accessed as the final TFS directory entry. [Note: The file would not be compatible with the keyboard monitor editor commands.] All system programs can be passed this file in the same manner an extended-length file would ordinarily be used. [Note: P?S/8 OS8CON has been altered to not check validity of the passed file block; when access to the minimalized extended-length single file entry is restored, OS8CON validity checking will be restored.]

```

BLOCK: 0:0064
0000 0124 0604 0014 0200 0411 2205 0324 0620 *ATFD@LB@DIRECTFP*
0010 2763 7200 0214 1303 2031 0643 0026 0200 *W3:@BLKCPYF#@VB@*
0020 2213 6415 0124 0671 0021 2200 0424 6415 *RK4MATF9@QR@DT4M*
0030 0124 0712 0014 2600 0424 0317 2031 0726 *ATGJ@LV@DTCOPYGV*
0040 0007 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@G@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0050 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0060 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0070 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0100 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0110 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0120 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0130 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0140 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0150 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0160 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0170 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*

```

Figure 3: Dump of Block 0064 of P?S/8 Version 8Z for TC08.

Figure 4 shows the contents of the third system programs directory block. This is provided primarily for completeness. No additional entries exist within the example directory past the second system programs directory block.

```
BLOCK: 0:0065
0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0010 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0020 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0030 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0040 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0050 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0060 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0070 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0100 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0110 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0120 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0130 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0140 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0150 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0160 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0170 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
```

Figure 4: Dump of Block 0065 of P?S/8 Version 8Z for TC08.

Figure 5 shows the contents of the fourth and final system programs directory block. Relative word[177] contains the first available block for additional system programs. All released P?S/8 systems provide a small number of spare blocks to allow additional programs to be added. There are no utilities available to aid in the creation of additional system programs; advanced users are familiar enough with P?S/8 as documented within this document to successfully add additional programs. In this particular example, blocks 0735-0777 are available for additional system programs. [Note: The TFS directory for this system is the documented example in another document detailing P?S/8 TFS directories. The TFS files for this system start in block 1000.]

Temporary system programs can be created by use of the R % or R \$ command. When binary files are loaded and saved to the system save area [using the GET command or similar], it is possible to run the image as if in the system programs directory via this command.

The only restriction on such usage is the inability to define overlay structures such as are used in P?S?8 PAL and P?S?8 FOCAL; proper implementation requires additional knowledge of P?S/8 internal operations.

```
BLOCK: 0:0066
0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0010 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0020 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0030 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0040 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0050 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0060 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0070 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0100 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0110 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0120 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0130 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0140 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0150 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0160 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@@*
0170 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0735 *@@@@@@@@@@@@@G]*
```

Figure 5: Dump of Block 0066 of P?S/8 Version 8Z for TC08.

[end-of-file]